

Week 8: Video Transcript

Hello everyone and welcome back to our eighth class module. I'm so happy to be here with you and we'll start today's class lesson, all about empowered conversations and non-violent compassionate communications, by taking a look back and beginning with some reflection. This is an excellent time to pause and really take note of how things are integrating for you. It's a great time to notice the tiny shifts that you have made in your parenting. Sometimes in this process, it can seem as if we're taking one step forward and about 500,000 steps backwards. And that's very normal. This is not a linear path. This is not always easy and comfortable. I want to normalize that this is a process of waking up every day and rededicating ourselves to the pillars, to being aware of our body, being aware of our thermometer and our nervous system, being aware of our triggers, limiting beliefs, and the stories and judgments that we hold. Practicing catching ourselves when we're falling into power over or under parenting and making an intentional decision to shift gears into empowerment. Even if it's really uncomfortable and your body is full of fear and resistance, we're practicing building those muscles, and muscles only get stronger. Your inner security, sense of safety, and trust with this process, get stronger by practicing and showing up imperfectly every day.

I'm going to give you just a minute or two of silent reflection and be here with you as you maybe take note, maybe write down a few bullet points of little victories that you have experienced thus far in this program. It could be, maybe you're now able to listen to your child when they're speaking, where before you weren't able to slow down and give them your full presence. Or maybe now you are learning how to give your feelings a name. You never knew how to do that before and to connect them with a need. So we can go ahead and pause this audio for just a couple of minutes, and I highly encourage if you're a person that's like, "Oh, I'll do that later. I'm not going to do that right now". I highly encourage you to do it right now. Pause the audio and write a list of three to five tiny victories that you have experienced thus far in our program. Welcome back. I know that you just pressed pause and wrote three to five things that have changed in your parenting or within yourself so far in this program. And if you're cooking dinner and listening to this with headphones and there's no way that that's possible, then please by all means come back. Your coach will be here to check in on your tiny victories in your call too. Let's keep going.



We are a week away from introducing the core framework of our Jai methodology. We've given you a lot of beautiful frameworks, strategies, tools, and information to satiate your head, heart and hands of empowered parenting, and we have one more layer before we get into the five step process that we are dedicated to utilizing in any conflict to replace punishment, threat, bribe, any kind of enforced upon consequence, or any kind of power over or under strategy. The peace process is the essence of our work here at Jai. So before we get there, we're going to the voice. The voice of empowered parenting. This is learning how to have empowered conversations. You have a lovely workbook to accompany this lesson today. You can go ahead and take it out right now if you'd like, or you can revisit it once this lecture is over and we'll start by introducing what empowered conversations are and why we use them. We're learning how to take everything that you've been given so far in this process and bring it to this actualization point of being able to communicate what's happening for you. Being able to communicate what your body is experiencing, what your brain is experiencing, what your emotion and your feelings are, the needs you have, and bring them to a conversation to create connection, understanding and coherence.

Most of us were raised in power over or under communication patterns where our voices were not heard as children. The parent had the ultimate say, there was no space for negotiation. It was not a two-way street. It was not a consensus. It was not a democracy, by any means. And most of us are used to kind of steam rolling conversations, or we're used to stuffing it all inside and not saying anything, and really disguising our inner world as, "It's fine. It doesn't matter. It's okay. I don't really know". And this has to do with our attachment. More of that anxious attachment is going to be the power over: the shaming, the criticizing, the yelling, the comparisons, the judgments, and having a very short fuse. We're not able to really articulate what's happening in our world. We jump into reactivity with our voice. Or we have the more ambivalent attachment style, which is the faint or the freeze in the nervous system. It's beliefs like conflict isn't safe, or my voice doesn't matter, so I'm just going to go quiet and I'm not going to talk, and I'm not going to stand up for myself. I'm going to be in self-blame, self-shame, self-judgment. You might find yourself in both of these arenas, oscillating throughout your day. That's very normal. And of course, we're here to begin the process of being more in the middle, in the empowerment, more often in our parenting. A friend and family therapist told my husband and I at the beginning of our marriage that to succeed and have a healthy partnership, we need to have a PHD in communication, and he was not joking. This expands out into our communication with our children as well. Being able to have integrous communication and make space for our children's voices to be heard, and model for them how to communicate our inner world from a place of self-acceptance, unconditional love, and safety. We feel safe having feelings.

We feel safe having needs. We feel safe expressing ourselves and communicating what's going on for us inside of our head, our heart, and our hands. We're wanting our children to grow up with these expansive beliefs as well. So in our workbook, we have the power over communication pattern laid out for you and the power under pattern. Just noticing in your communication with your children, your partner, your co-parent, your parents, your friends, anyone, this goes for any relationship in yourself, how you talk to yourself, do you use power over or under. And just become aware and catch yourself so you can make a choice to go forward.

So we learn about what gets in the way of being in right relationship with nonviolent communication and having conversations that empower, versus having conversations that are rooted in blaming, shaming, and dumping our feelings onto our children and wanting them to be responsible for how we feel. As we're learning, it's not our children's behaviors that trigger us and make us feel a certain way. It is how our neuroception is perceiving them, how our nervous system and our brain are interacting, the limiting beliefs and the stored emotions and memories in our amygdala that are being fired, our inability to know and name what we're experiencing, which snowballs our stress, and we react. And that's happening in a millisecond, of course. So we're learning that it's not about our children's behavior, it's about our lack of safety on the inside, our lack of awareness of what's happening, our lack of accessibility to name what it is, and to express it. So we're no longer living in the paradigm of projecting our inner world and putting it onto the behavior of the child. Most of our children's behavior is absolutely age appropriate, developmentally appropriate, and it's their best attempt to communicate how they're experiencing their inner world. They need modeling. They need help being able to communicate. It takes years and years and years of practice. So because we didn't get those formative years of practicing, we are starting now and it's going to be imperfect.

We have an opportunity for you in the workbook to become clear on the belief system you have about your voice and about feelings, needs, and your right to express them. Is conflict safe or is conflict dangerous? Is having differing opinions safe or dangerous? Is having needs safe or dangerous? Is having feelings safe or dangerous? We have learned how to make sense of having feelings, needs, and an inner world, and whether or not we are worthy and deserving to be able to communicate it. We're up against some internal conditioned patterns and barriers that we can absolutely soften and make a transformation. I absolutely believe that that's possible for you. If you are someone who slips into yelling, criticizing, focusing on the negative, dismissing, comparison and judgment, this is human. It's normal. A lot of us are stuck in those habits and behaviors.



There's something wrong with you. You're not broken. You're not a bad, terrible person at all. You're learning. We want to have the mind of a child as we are making our way through this learning. We have to have an open mind and see this as an opportunity, an invitation to discover, to be challenged, to grow, and not get bogged down in all the ways we're not showing up good enough in our parenting and in our communication. We move on into the 10 steps of how to have an empowered conversation. I have this laid out for you very specifically, and we'll take you step by step.

One of the most important parts of having an empowered conversation is taking responsibility for your inner world. So we're not saying things like, "Well, if you wouldn't have hit your sister, then I wouldn't have had to yell, or I wouldn't have had to be angry if you would've just done what I told you to do the first time." We're no longer enmeshed in our children's behaviors, we're taking responsibility for them. We're practicing being able to communicate vulnerably. We're making sure that we're asking our children consent before we share with them how we're feeling, what needs are coming up for us, and the requests that we have, instead of dumping it onto them and having them be our emotional caretaker. Our children are not our emotional caretakers. It's the opposite, and it's normal and healthy for your children to witness you modeling expressing yourself. They are not going to know how to express their feelings and needs, how to make clear requests instead of demands, how to share their stories, their thoughts, and their dreams, unless you're doing it too. We're just wanting to do it with intention and consciousness so that we are very aware of, "My intention is to express myself with you and let you in on my world so we feel more connected and understood", instead of coming to my child and wanting them to take care of me and my feelings.

And there's nothing wrong with receiving care. Children are learning empathy so they have this intrinsic desire to connect to you, and when they see someone in emotional pain or psychological pain, they want to be comforting. My son and I have a lot of vulnerable conversations because I make a lot of mistakes with this child. I'm apologizing every day and I'm communicating all day long. And the joke really is, "Am I just supposed to just sit around all day talking with my children?" Yes, you are. I know that sounds really inconvenient, but what's really inconvenient is a life of separation, disconnection, internalized shame, criticism, judgment, only communicating to prove your point, to be right, and to be dominating. That is exhausting. That is inconvenient. This is really looking at relationship and the parent-child dynamic through a whole different lens. It does slow down your day. It does slow down your lifestyle. It does make things take longer. So in the future, there is rapid collaboration and cooperation and it doesn't take that long because there's been so much practice.

A lot of us are very shortsighted in our parenting and don't have the long-term vision. I understand that that's difficult because long-term vision comes from the prefrontal cortex, which is what we learn is grown by receiving empathy, having vulnerable conversations, understanding your parents inner world, and having a secure attachment.

So I understand why it seems really daunting and difficult for you to imagine really slowing down and talking to your child a lot and spending a lot of time communicating. We're wanting to look at empowered conversations, as I've mentioned, with the intention of going in and really understanding and connecting. There's no going in and wanting to prove a point, wanting to be right, and wanting to show that your child that you're bigger, stronger, you're the winner, and you're going to win this conversation. Everyone is equal in this conversation and we're here to talk it through. An empowered conversation is something that can happen in the moment organically after you've had enough practice, or it's something that you set aside and it's more of a formal conversation that you make a plan for and then you engage in. We learn together how to differentiate a request from a demand. This is very important that we're able to understand when we are going into commanding and demanding, and when we are going into authentic requests, which has spaciousness, possibility, and creativity.

Our children developmentally under the age of seven and under the age of 11 or 12 especially, they are probably going to speak in command and demand. "I want an apple, I want it now", and a lot of parents get really upset by the way their children are talking to them. It's completely developmentally appropriate. They're learning how to stand in their "I" statements and in their ego, it's actually really healthy. What we're wanting to do is respond to them with a, "I hear you, you're wanting it immediately, and a really kind and compassionate way of saying that could be mama, is it okay if I have an apple, could you help me with that?" And I don't expect my child to be able to say that, I don't hold the apple over their head and wait until they repeat those words back to me before I give it to them, because that's coercion, manipulation, and control. I am trusting that when I am modeling my communication for my children, they are going to internalize it and they are going to speak it. I've not had to formally teach my daughter how to communicate compassionately. I've modeled it. When she screamed at me for the first six years of her life to get her things, I was not reactive in punishing. I was trusting and reminding myself that I get to teach her right now. She's learning how to communicate. Now she's eight and she speaks like a queen. It's incredible, and it's just pure modeling. I haven't had to teach her how to do it. Really trusting that when you're modeling these things for your children, they're going to pick them up.



Like every other tool that we've gone over together, empowered conversations happen from within. The success of our empowered conversation with another person is determined by our intimacy and our trust in this process. So you'll have this in your workbook and you'll be able to have conversations with yourself. How many of you have a very strong inner critic? How many of you are constantly beating yourself up on the inside, which is heartbreaking. Maybe you talk really negatively to yourself, or have really painful inner dialogue. You get to have an empowered conversation with yourself. Look in the mirror and have this conversation with whatever voice in your head it is. Maybe it's the voice telling you that you're not good enough, or maybe that was your dad telling you that when you were a kid, or it was your third grade teacher. Who knows whose voices you've internalized. You get to journal it and have a conversation with the voices in your head so you're not living in fear.

Last week, I said that having emotional intelligence it's like having freedom, and I really believe that freedom is not living in fear of our thoughts, not living in fear of the voices in our head, of our feelings, our needs, or our voice. The empowered conversation is an inward process that you can take out with your children.

I'm so excited for you to have this framework and these tools. My challenge and my invitation for you this week is to really study this workbook and have an empowered conversation. Even if it doesn't go well at all, even if it's really choppy and awkward, and you only remember one of the 10 steps, try it. Have these 10 steps on your fridge, share it with your partner if you have one, let them know that you're trying to improve your communication style because you want your family to feel connected and empowered, and to trust each other and to have the tools to be able to communicate, so you're not reacting and you're not living in terror of the inside of your head, your heart, or your hands. I'm so glad that you're here. Thank you so much for your willingness and your commitment to show up, be imperfect, to have curiosity, and to learn. Any questions that you have about this, about the workbook, the tools that we're giving you, take it to your coach and they'll help you unpack it. They'll help you get through those barriers, that's what they're here for. You are supported, you are cared for, and I appreciate you. Thank you so much.

